



LYRA RECORDER

User Manual · Version 1.0

1. Introduction

Lyra Recorder is a professional audio capture application for Android. It is designed for two distinct contexts: spontaneous capture, where speed matters more than perfection, and controlled capture, where the device calibrates itself to the microphone and environment before recording.

This manual covers everything you need to start recording in either mode.

2. Two recording modes

Direct REC

Press REC and capture starts immediately. No setup, no calibration. HPF, LIMITER and AUTO PAUSE are disabled in this mode. Use the GAIN knob while watching the meters to adjust the input level manually. Ideal for breaking news, spontaneous declarations and any situation where you cannot afford to wait.

Calibrated REC

Press CAL to launch a short calibration test. Once finished, all professional functions become available, tuned to your microphone and the room you are in. Then press REC. Ideal for interviews, conferences and controlled sessions.

3. The calibration test

Press CAL. The app guides you through two phases of five seconds each:

- **Phase 1 — Silence.** Stay quiet. Lyra measures the ambient noise floor of the room.
- **Phase 2 — Speak normally.** Talk as you would during the real recording. Lyra measures the microphone sensitivity and your typical voice level.

From those two measurements, Lyra computes the meter gain, the limiter threshold, and the auto-pause thresholds. It also decides whether AUTO PAUSE is viable in the current environment. If background noise is too high, AUTO PAUSE will be marked as unavailable and remain disabled, even if you try to activate it.

The CAL button turns from dim green to bright green once a valid profile is active. You can re-calibrate at any time, or every time you change rooms.

4. Controls

Control	Function
REC	Start recording. Available in both modes.
STOP	Stop the current recording and save the file.
MARK	During recording, tag the current position with a custom note.
CAL	Launch the session calibration test.
GAIN	Rotary knob. Adjust input level. Watch the meters as reference.
HPF	High-pass filter (~80 Hz). Removes low-frequency rumble (wind, traffic, handling noise). Requires calibration.
LIMITER	Hard ceiling on the signal. Prevents clipping. Requires calibration.
MONITOR	Live monitoring through connected headphones. Always available.
AUTO II	Auto-pause when silence is detected. 0 / 1s / 2s threshold. Requires calibration and a quiet environment.
P.BACK	Open the playback screen.
LIBRARY	Browse and manage saved recordings.

5. Meters

VU Meter

Analog-style needle from -20 dB to +3 dB. With the LIMITER active, the needle physically cannot exceed 0 dB — it stops at the threshold and remains there, regardless of how loud the source is. Without the LIMITER, the needle is free to swing across the full range.

Spectrum analyzer

64-band representation of the signal. Bars are colored green, amber and red according to level. Useful for spotting where energy concentrates (low end, midrange, high end).

Waveform

Live time-domain view of the signal. Confirms that audio is actually being captured and reveals transient peaks before they show up on the VU.

6. Playback

Press P.BACK to open the playback screen. Each recording offers two views: an overview waveform of the entire file and a zoomed detail view centered on the current position. Use the transport controls below to play, pause and navigate. The -30s, -10s, +10s and +30s buttons let you jump precisely.

Markers added during recording appear on the timeline. Tap a marker to jump directly to that position and see its note.

7. Files and formats

Lyra supports two output formats: **WAV** (uncompressed, 16-bit PCM at 44.1 kHz, recommended for editing and archiving) and **AAC** (compressed at 256 kbit/s, recommended for sharing and storage). Choose the default format in the Library screen.

Recordings are stored locally on the device and can be exported or shared through the standard Android share menu.

8. Practical tips

- Calibrate in the same room and at the same distance from the microphone you will use during the recording. Re-calibrate when you change rooms.
- If AUTO PAUSE is unavailable, the environment is too noisy. Find a quieter location or disable AUTO PAUSE expectations.
- Use HPF outdoors or near fans, traffic and wind. Disable it for studio-quiet rooms.
- Use LIMITER when you cannot control the source volume (live event, raised voices, unpredictable speakers).
- Mark significant moments during the recording. Reviewing marked positions later is much faster than scrubbing the whole file.